PLURVA-LLM · AACL-IJCNLP 2026 · ORAL

NepPlural

A Human-Anchored Benchmark for Persona Annotation in Nepali Migration Discourse

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github.com/iriis-research/NepPlural

arXiv 2610.15732

Standard alignment collapses contested views into one answer

Standard alignment
RLHF, DPO



Pluralistic alignment
Sorensen et al., 2024



> On contested questions, the “average” drifts toward a Western-majority default.

Pluralistic datasets are Western-skewed, and Nepali has no persona resource

PRISM

Almost no South Asian participants; none from Nepal

OpinionQA · GlobalOpinionQA

Built from Western survey instruments

Cultural evaluations

Surveys or translated probes, not naturalistic text

Nepali

NER and POS tagging exist; no persona or value resource

Youth migration is Nepal's most contested debate, argued in code-mixed text

Economic necessity · Family duty · Anger at the state · Patriotism

ROMANIZED NEPALI

rahar ley haina badhyata ley ho hajur

"It is not by choice but out of compulsion, sir."

NEPALI + ENGLISH

Manxe bides gaye ra xaena. desh xodi raxa hits hard

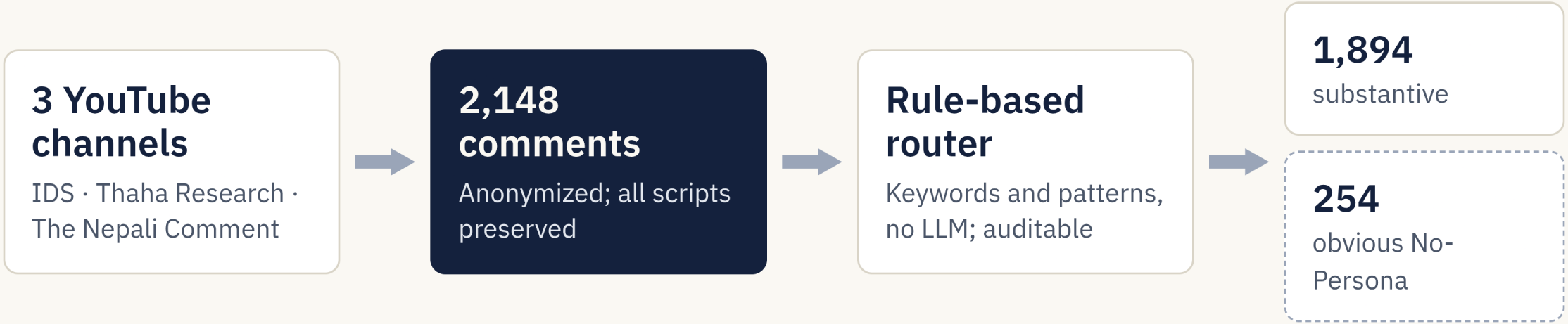
"It is not just that people went abroad; the country is being abandoned. It hits hard."

ENGLISH

I want to go home but I can't

Trapped, family-driven, despairing

We collected 2,148 real comments and routed them without any LLM



> From the substantive pool: a 300-comment stratified sample for human gold.

Each comment gets four persona axes, or an explicit No-Persona

Intent
- Pro-Migration
- Anti-Migration
- Trapped / Regretful
- Neutral / Observation

Primary Driver
- Economic Necessity
- Family Obligation
- Systemic / Political Anger
- Patriotism / Love

Value Orientation
- Collectivist (Family)
- Collectivist (Nation)
- Individualist (Self)

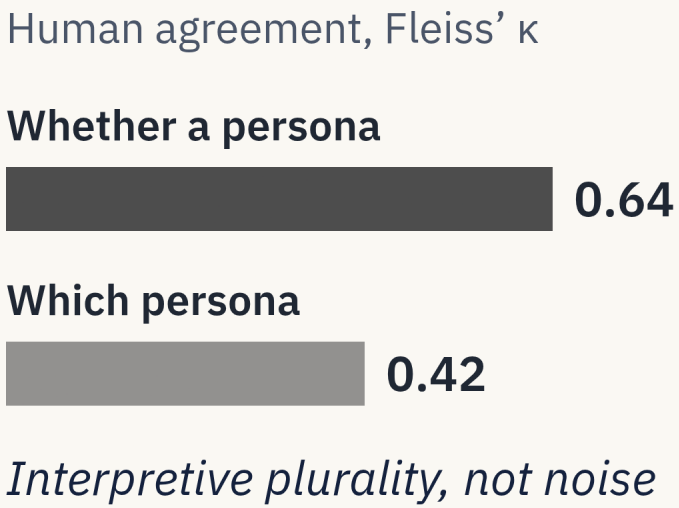
Affect
- Despairing
- Angry
- Hopeful
- Pragmatic

+ No-Persona no migration stance: generic praise, channel shout-outs, off-topic

Native speakers often judge that a comment carries no persona

38.7%

of substantive-looking comments express **no persona** (116 of 300)



Interpretive plurality, not noise

300 comments · 3 native speakers, independent · mean κ = 0.55 · scoring uses leave-one-annotator-out references; a held-out native speaker = 0.75 macro-F1

We audited three annotation protocols with the same models and instructions

GPT-5.2 · Gemini 3.5 Flash · Claude Sonnet 4.6

Batched chat

20–50 comments per chat

Forced choice · CSV

Per-comment, forced

One comment per API call

Forced choice · JSON

Per-comment, abstain

One comment per API call

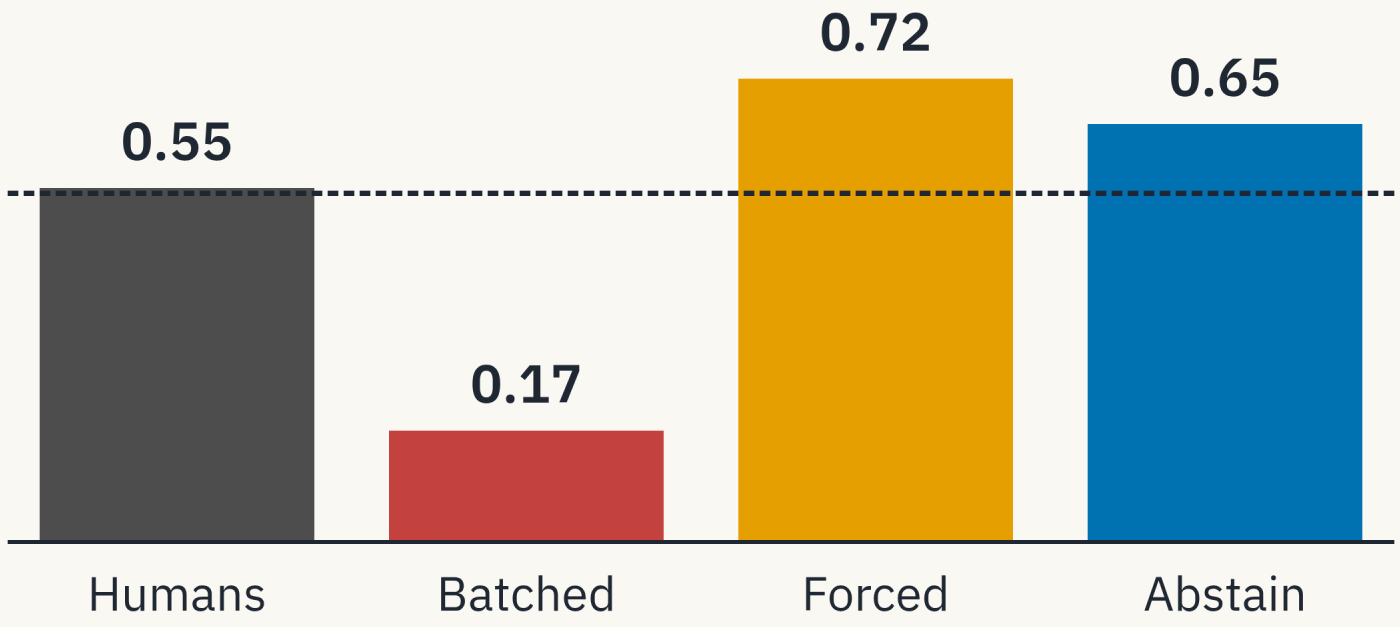
No-Persona allowed · JSON

Batched vs. per-comment: bundles batching, interface, format and settings

Forced vs. abstain: controlled, only abstention differs

Finding 1: annotation agreement depends on the protocol

Mean Fleiss' κ (three raters per condition)



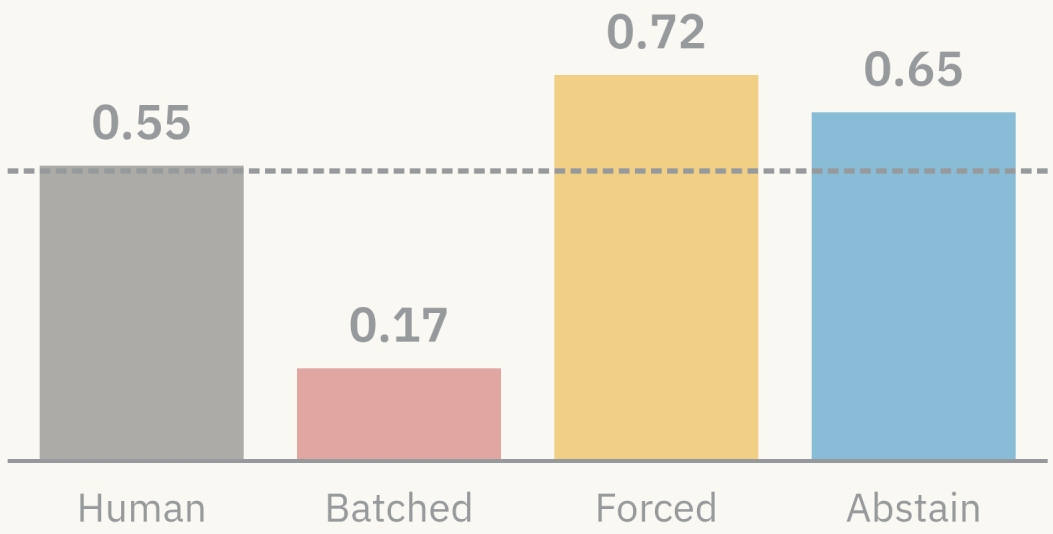
Same models, same instructions: near-chance → above human.

Low agreement ≠ models can't do the task.

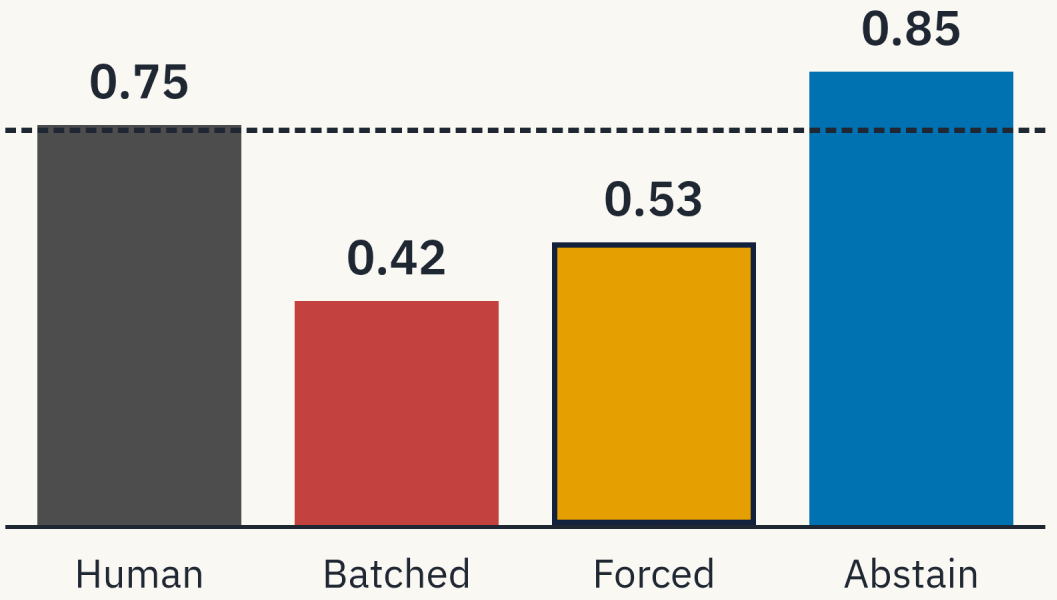
Dashed line: native speakers (κ 0.55)

Finding 2: agreement is not validity

(a) Agreement · Fleiss' κ



(b) Validity · LOO macro-F1



> Forced models assign personas to the 39% humans call No-Persona. On persona-only items they score 0.83–0.88.

Finding 3: letting models abstain fixes most of it

0.75–0.86

LOO macro-F1, vs. 0.75 for a held-out native speaker

0.79–0.87

No-Persona F1

5–16%

false abstentions

NOT PERFECT

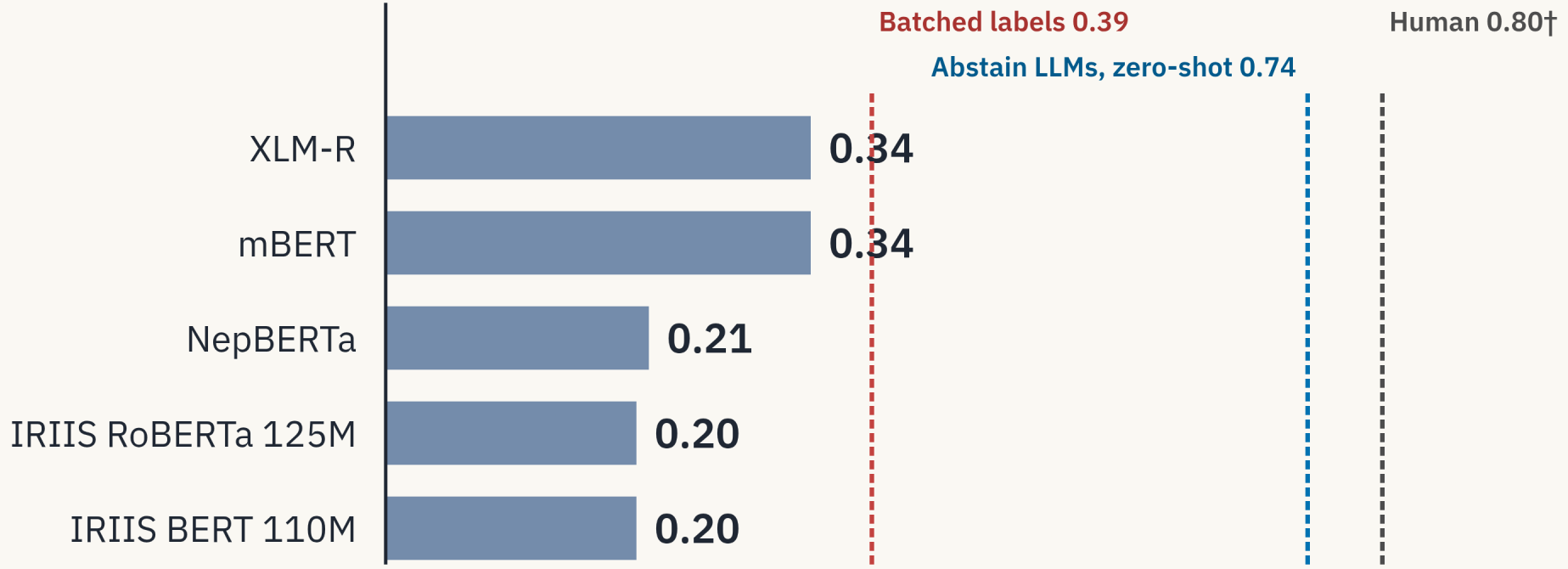
Genuine saving kati samma hunx uta

“How much can one genuinely save over there?”

Humans: No-Persona

All 3 abstaining models: Pro / Economic / Individualist / Pragmatic

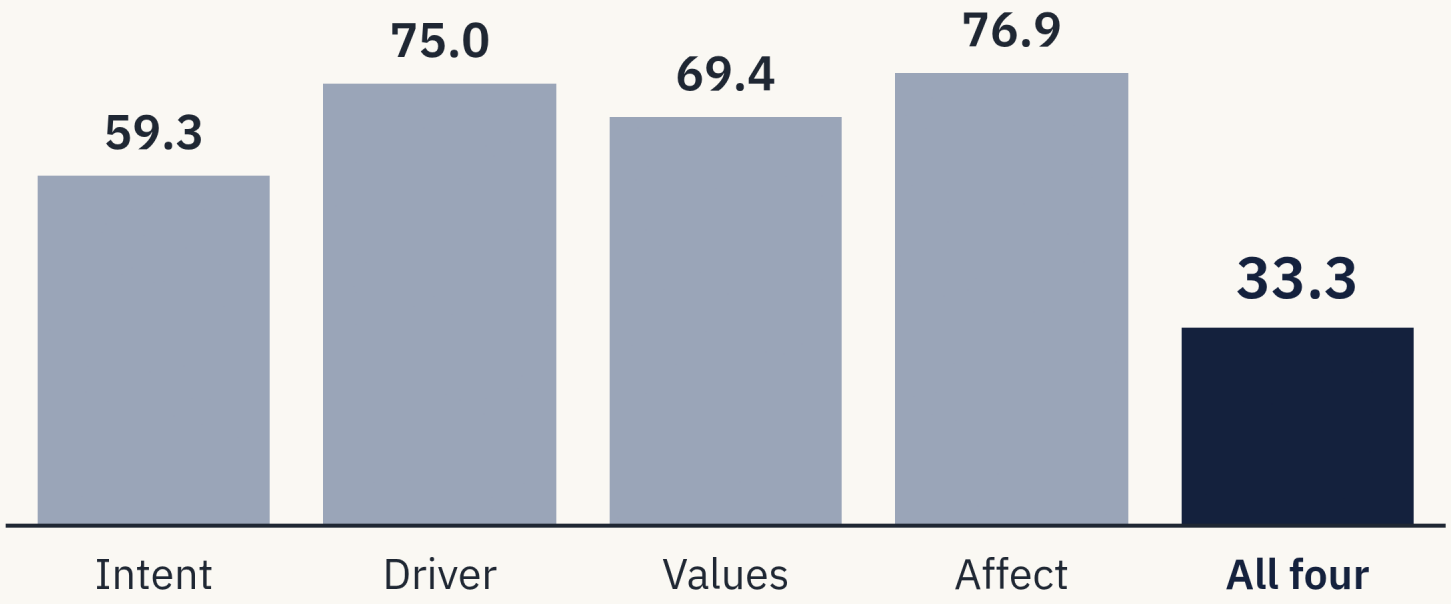
Encoders trained on batched labels inherit them: the labels are the bottleneck



Macro-F1 vs. gold, mean of 5 seeds. Nepali-specific ≈ 0.20 is confounded with pretraining scale. † not independent of gold.

Steered models adopt single persona traits, but rarely the whole persona

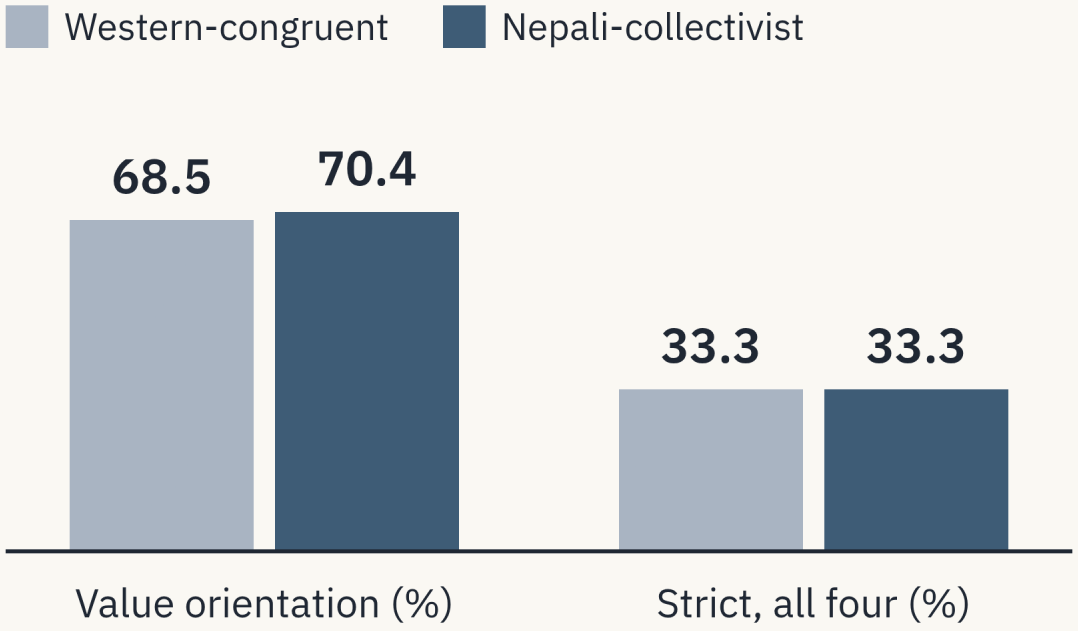
Fidelity to target persona, judged blind by native speakers (%)

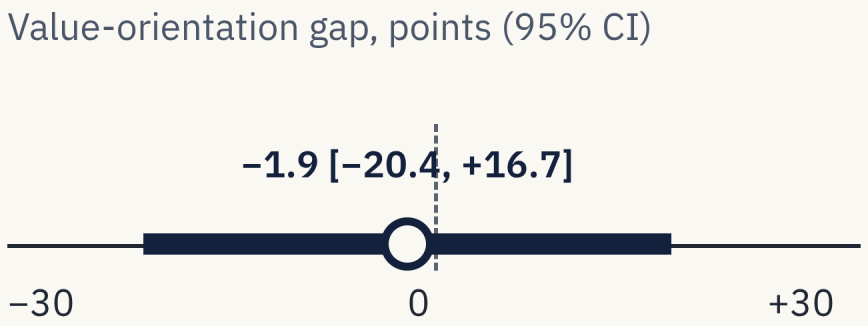


6 personas × 6 questions × 3 models = 108 generations

Claude Opus 4.6 · GPT 5.6 Luna · Gemini 3.6 Flash

We detect no Western-congruence gap, within a wide margin





Rules out only gaps ≳ 20 points. Per-model signs disagree: noise.

> The clearer limitation is compositional, not directional.

Audit the protocol, anchor on native speakers, let models abstain

1. **Reliability is a property of the protocol:** report and audit it.
2. **Agreement ≠ validity:** culturally situated labels need native-speaker gold.
3. **Abstention is a capability:** knowing when not to speak for someone.

Models adopt single persona traits but rarely compose full personas.

One domain, a small gold set and proprietary models: here is what comes next

Limitations

One domain, one platform

300-item gold; small script groups

Annotators on the research team

Bundled protocol contrast

Proprietary models only

Small steerability study

Next

Encoders on abstention labels

Open-weight models

Larger annotator pool

Other contested Nepali domains

More prompt phrasings

Thank you

Everything is released: data, individual and adjudicated human labels, prompts, all raw model outputs, code.

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github.com/iriis-research/NepPlural

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Scan for data, labels and code